

Expand Your World – German I – Introduction

Welcome to German I! If you're starting this course, it means you are new to the German language or are starting over again to relearn or master previously learned concepts. German is spoken by over 130 million people worldwide, either as a first or second language, making it a very useful world language. It is an official language of six different countries: Germany, Austria, Switzerland, Liechtenstein, Belgium, and Luxembourg. German is spoken in many different dialects across these countries, but the standardized official German is known as Hochdeutsch (High German). In this course, you'll be learning Hochdeutsch, but you'll also be exposed to some of the many main dialects.

This course will start out by introducing you to the most basic and foundational concepts of German. You'll begin to learn the most essential words with short, daily vocabulary lists. Study these words well and learn them as quickly as you can, but feel free to look up words in our recommended online dictionary if you want to know more as you go! Whenever you think of a word you want to use, look it up. These courses do NOT provide you with enough vocabulary to make you know all the words you need to know. We give you the foundation, but part of language learning is self-discovery and experience. This first course of German will introduce you to the language basics. Learn these vital concepts well to build yourself a strong foundation for the more advanced concepts later down the road.

Good Luck!

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This Email does NOT count as one of your typical lessons. This is a starter “mini-lesson” that just explains very important pronunciation rules. I do not expect you to learn all of them right now, I just want to introduce them to you. Throughout the lessons, we put in constant pronunciation reminders; however, it is a good idea to read over this intro every day for the first few weeks! These pronunciation rules can be the difference between being understood and being looked at funny.

Here are some very important sounds in German...

- In German, the EI and AI make the same sound as the English word, “Eye”
- In German, the IE makes the same sound as the name of the English letter E (aka, the sound in the word Bee)
- In German, the W makes the English V sound
- In German, the V makes the English F sound
- In German, the J makes the English Y sound
- In German, S will make the English Z sound at the beginning of a syllable, and the English S sound everywhere else,

EXCEPT...

- In German, SP makes the SHP sound
- In German, ST makes the SHT sound
- In German, SCH makes a similar sound to the English SH kind of mixed with CH
- In German, the TSCH makes the English CH sound with a slight T at the beginning (sort of - you’ll master this as we go)
- In German, the CH sometimes makes the English K (rarely) sound, sometimes the English SH (commonly) sound, and sometimes it's a rough guttural (commonly) sound like in the word LOCH NESS

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- In German, AU makes the English OW sound (the sound you make when getting hurt)
- In German, ÄU and OI and EU make the English OY/OI sound (like in Boy)
- In German, E at the end of the word IS pronounced. It's kind of pronounced like a U as in BUD
- In German, QU makes the English KV sound
- In German, TH makes the English T sound

Now, for the real lessons - each will have a list of **Words of the Day**. These words are vital to memorize. There usually are no more than 10 words to keep your straight memorization focused on the most essential vocabulary. If you can learn each list each day, you'll gain a great vocabulary quickly. You'll be exposed to more words throughout lesson examples and readings.

Each email also has a **Grammar Bit of the Day**. This section will cover 1-3 grammar topics each day. This will slowly work in the important things that you have to know while not overwhelming you all at once. This will be, however, the hardest part at times. So, PLEASE, ask questions whenever you have them. Also, if you have your instructor lessons, your instructor will make sure to go over all of the grammar (and words) to make sure you understand them.

After the first few lessons, almost all of the lessons will also have a reading of the day. This will provide a small reading in German (with an English translation) so you can gain vocabulary, watch new grammar concepts being used, and reinforce all that you're learning. Hopefully it'll also clear things up and provide more examples for what you've learned previously. When you read each day, you'll soon notice yourself reading quite a bit of German, and sooner or later, speaking and understanding it.

Tschüss!
(Bye)